NO. 1
DECEMBER 2026

GUIDED CHILDHOOD NEWS

AGES 6 TO 11
PRINT, READ, DO

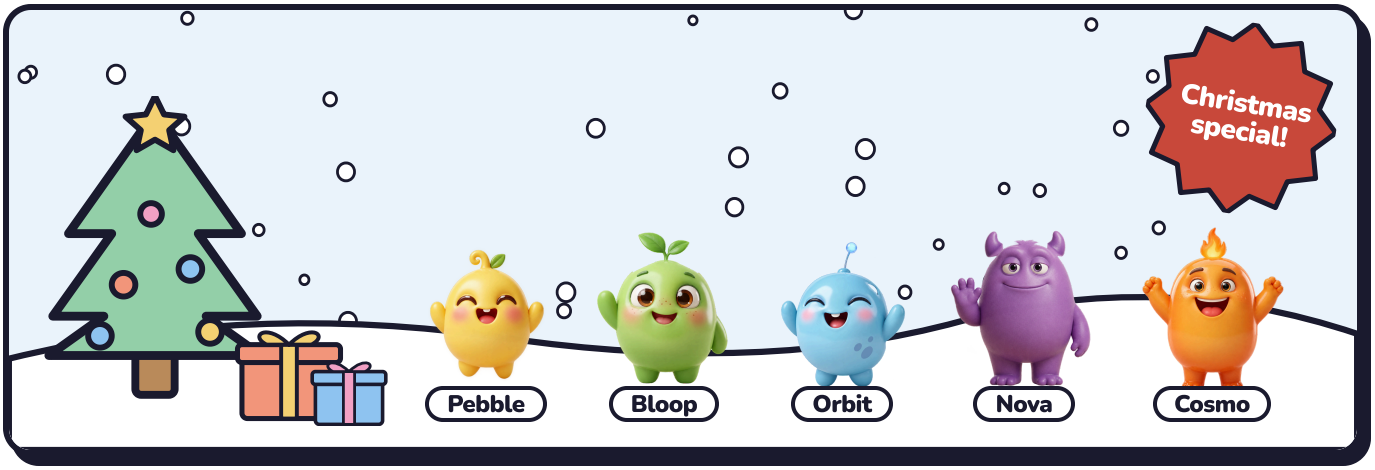
The Guided Times

Happy news for growing up with screens

CHRISTMAS EDITION · NEW SCREENS UNDER THE TREE · GUIDEDCHILDHOOD.COM

FRONT PAGE NEWS

Something new under the tree?



The Planet Friends, ready for a cosy Christmas. One Friend for every stage of growing up.

This Christmas, lots of children will unwrap a tablet, a games console or a first phone. If that is you, hooray! But here is the big news: the best bit is not the box. It is setting it up together.

This is a free taster of the paper. Turn over for your new screen's ID card and Orbit's Christmas puzzles, then the Christmas morning plan on the last page.

IN THE FULL ISSUE

2 A letter from DiGi
3 The Christmas morning plan
5 The big question
6 The app desk
7 The homework helper
8 The good sites guide
9 Orbit's puzzles
10 Make and do
11 The shop
12 Your Christmas promise



"The best thing we did was choose where it sleeps before we even switched it on."

COSMO, THE FRIEND FOR 16 AND UP

SCREEN WEATHER

Christmas Day: bright and cosy indoors, a strong chance of board games after lunch, and screens resting during dinner.

☆ My new screen's ID card

FILL IT IN TOGETHER

Draw your new screen here

It is a: (circle one)

Tablet Console Phone Laptop

Its name is .....

It sleeps in the .....

Its bedtime is .....

If something feels wrong I tell .....

My first three apps

1 .....

2 .....

3 .....

Our protected times: ☐ Meals ☐ Bedtime ☐ Car journeys ☐ Christmas dinner

Draw your screen in its bed

WHERE WILL IT CHARGE TONIGHT?





My name ..... Grown up .....



ORBIT'S CHRISTMAS PUZZLES

Real or pretend?

Three messages arrived on Christmas Eve. Circle real or pretend for each one.

1

FROM: PRIZE TEAM

You have WON a free tablet! Tap the link and type your address to claim it.

Real Pretend

2

FROM: GRANDMA

Thank you for my drawing! It is on my fridge. Love you lots.

Real Pretend

3

FROM: PARCEL DELIVERY

Your present is stuck. Pay £1.99 now to send it today.

Real Pretend

Christmas screen word search

Y	P	D	H	J	T	E	L	L	D
B	P	N	F	X	B	P	G	U	V
P	P	Z	X	B	P	A	U	S	E
T	A	B	L	E	T	C	M	S	Y
K	I	N	D	Z	V	H	Y	T	H
M	M	V	G	F	M	A	G	A	F
M	M	C	F	A	V	R	F	R	S
Z	A	S	K	Z	M	G	N	Y	A
F	X	S	N	O	W	E	X	Y	F
U	N	M	H	P	Y	U	M	H	E

- ☐ tablet
- ☐ charge
- ☐ pause
- ☐ kind
- ☐ safe
- ☐ ask
- ☐ tell
- ☐ snow
- ☐ game
- ☐ star

Crack the code

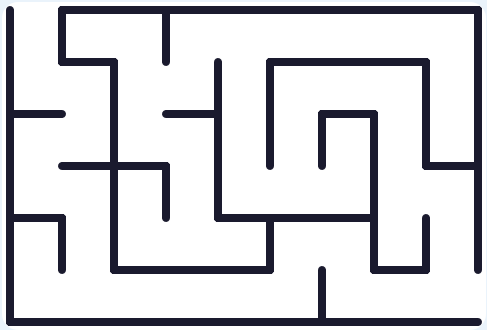
A is 1, B is 2, C is 3, all the way to Z is 26. What do you do if something online feels wrong?

☐	☐	☐	☐		☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
19	20	15	16		3	12	15	19	5

☐	☐	☐	☐
20	5	12	12

Help Tabby find its bed

START HERE



BED

The Christmas morning plan

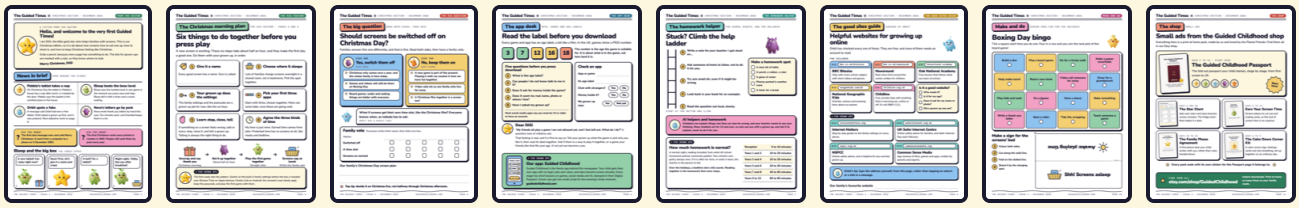
SIX THINGS TO DO TOGETHER

Before a new tablet, console or phone is switched on, do these six together, in order. The full issue gives each one a page of its own.

1. **Give it a name**
2. **Choose where it sleeps**
3. **Your grown up does the settings**
4. **Pick your first three apps**
5. **Learn stop, close, tell**
6. **Agree the three kinds of time**

Liked it? There are eight more pages

The big question, the app desk, the homework helper, good websites, Boxing Day bingo and the page turning version for any screen.

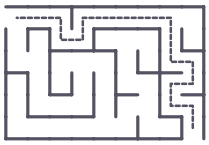


THE FULL ISSUE
The Guided Times, in our Etsy shop: GuidedChildhood



What stage is your child?

Three questions, no sign up, and you get the plan that fits their age:
guidedchildhood.com/starter-pack





ORBIT'S ANSWERS

1 is pretend: real prizes never need your address from a message.
2 is real: Grandma, and she wants nothing from you.
3 is pretend: ask a grown up before you ever pay for anything.
The code says: stop close tell. Stop, close it, and tell a grown up.